

**ADVISORY (THURSDAY 6PM): OA4P HOLDS CITY-WIDE RALLY WITH DRS.  
GHASSAN ABU-SITTAH, TAMIM AL-BARGHOUTI**

*OA4P Expects Massive Turnout for Rally with Prominent Speakers In Response to  
Admin's Refusal to Negotiate*

15 May 2024; OXFORD, UK -- On Thursday evening, the Oxford Action for Palestine (OA4P) coalition will host a rally and press conference in city centre with prominent Palestinian speakers Drs. Ghassan Abu-Sittah and Tamim Al-Barghouti. The emergency rally was announced in direct response to Tuesday's disappointing statement from the Vice Chancellor, which – after a week of silence – was issued to the university community with a complete refusal to engage with OA4P's demands or meet to discuss them further. On Tuesday evening, OA4P issued a public response which condemned the University's inaction and called for immediate negotiations. The response can be found among other press releases in OA4P's press kit, at [linktr.ee/OxAct4Pal](https://linktr.ee/OxAct4Pal).

Tuesday's response from the Vice Chancellor prompted fury across the University community after over a week of momentum for OA4P's Gaza Solidarity Encampment, which has garnered widespread support and nearly quadrupled in size since its founding. Endorsements for OA4P and its demands have been issued by over 500 members of University faculty and staff, Oxford University healthcare workers, and over ten Oxford trade union affiliates, including Oxford UCU and the Oxford and District Trade Unions Council.

**WHAT:** OA4P Emergency Rally and Press Conference, feat. Dr. Ghassan Abu-Sittah and Dr. Tamim Al-Barghouti

**WHEN:** Thursday, 16 May, 18:00

**WHERE:** Clarendon Building, University of Oxford, OX1 3AZ

**Dr. Ghassan Abu-Sittah** is the Rector of the University of Glasgow and prominent British-Palestinian surgeon. He has made international news in recent months for his advocacy for Gaza. **Dr. Tamim Al-Barghouti** is a Palestinian-Egyptian poet, columnist and political scientist. Nicknamed the "poet of Jerusalem", he is one of the most widely read poets in the Arab World.

**QUOTE FROM OA4P:** "We have called for this rally in direct response to the University's unacceptable inaction on our demands. In the week since our encampment has gone up, the devastation in Gaza has increased exponentially. Israel has intensified its genocidal assault with ground invasions, forced displacement, blockage of aid and evacuations, and unrelenting carpet bombing. A seventh mass grave has been discovered at a Gaza hospital. The Rafah ground invasion — once considered a "red line" — has commenced. The circumstances could not be more urgent, and Gaza cannot wait. "

**For interviews and other enquiries, contact:**

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*Oxford Action for Palestine (OA4P) is a broad coalition of students, faculty, staff, and other members of the University of Oxford community who are dedicated to the liberation of Palestine. On 6 May, OA4P established a Liberated Zone encampment in solidarity with Gaza, calling on the University to cut financial, institutional, and rhetorical support of Israeli genocide, occupation, and apartheid. For updates, visit the OA4P linktree at [linktr.ee/OxAct4Pal](https://linktr.ee/OxAct4Pal) and find us on Instagram, X, and TikTok on @OxAct4Pal.*

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